

The peacock with the most splendid tail will attract the most peahens. Its bright tail will be passed on to its male offspring, which will find it similarly easy to attract mates.

Building on the theory

Many of Darwin's and Wallace's ideas have proved remarkably accurate, despite the fact that the workings of genetics were not understood at the time. Although Darwin himself had used the term "genetic" as an adjective to describe the as-yet-unknown mechanism of inheritance, it was British biologist William Bateson, in the early 20th century, who first used the term "genetics" in a description of the scientific process. In 1930, British